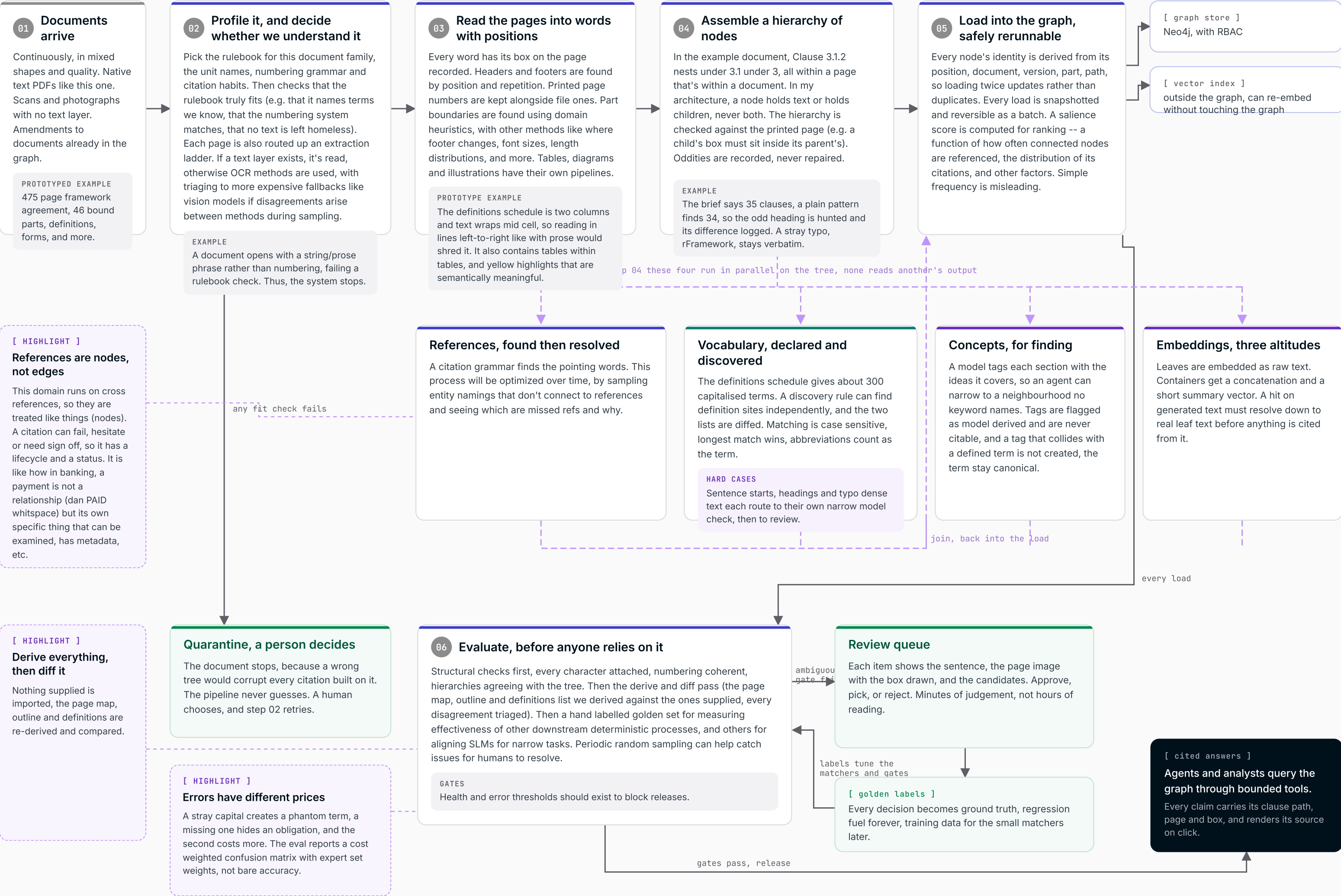




One question through the graph

An agent decomposes a real question across the three tiers. Paths and titles checked against the document, the scenario is illustrative.

- structure, deterministic

- vocabulary, rule derived

- concepts, model derived

- normalised external

Dan Porder, September
2026

THE BUYER ASKS

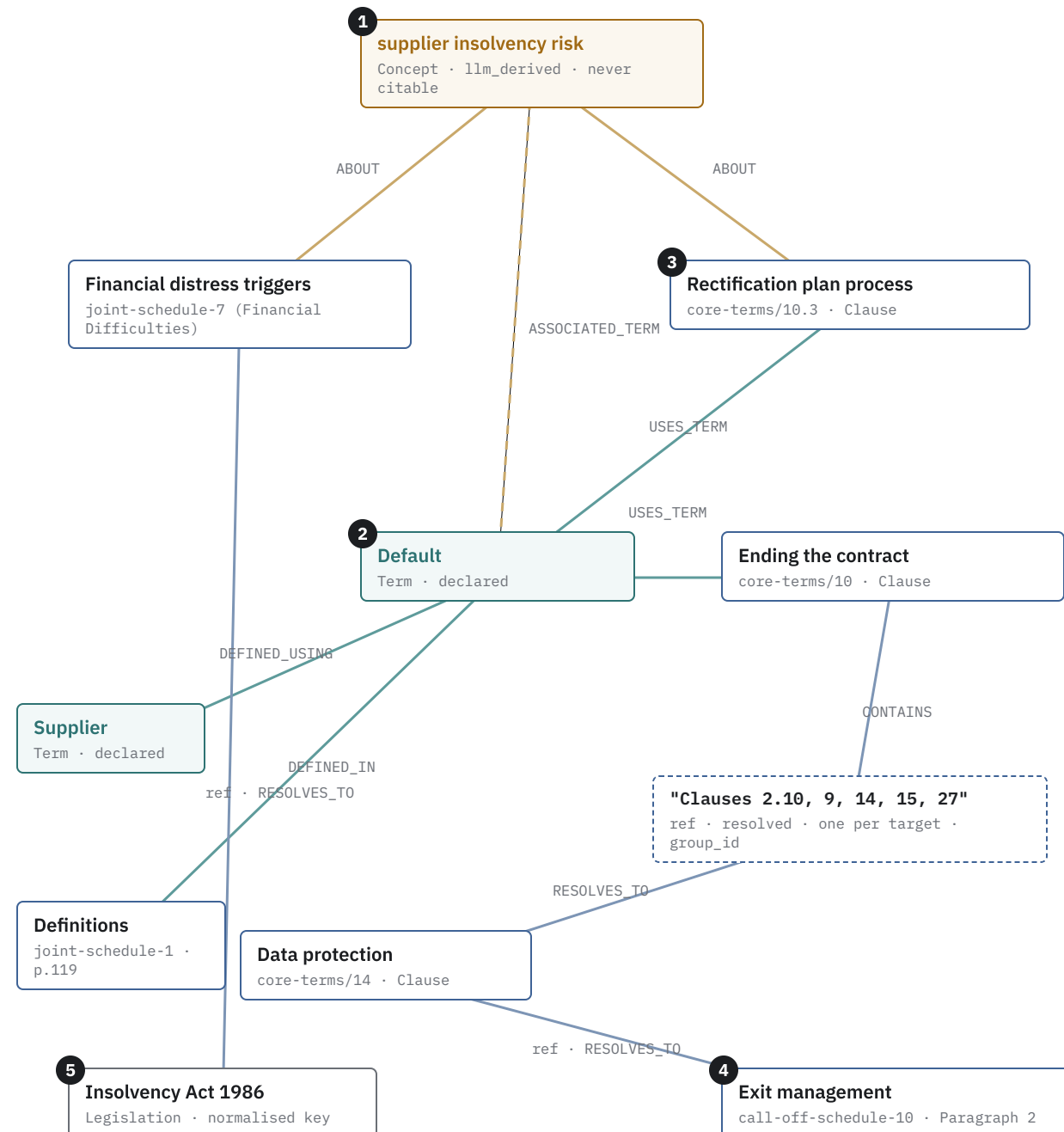
"Our supplier on a networks call-off has just filed accounts suggesting financial distress, and part of the delivery runs through a subcontractor in another jurisdiction. What are our options, what notice do we owe, and what happens to exit if it comes to that?"

THE AGENT DECOMPOSES IT

No single query answers this. Each focused query hits the tier built to answer it, and each partial answer carries its citations.

- 1 `find_by_concept("supplier insolvency risk")`
concepts narrow the neighbourhood, tier 3
- 2 `define("Default")`
the defined machinery, tier 2, with its dependency chain
- 3 `get_provision("core-terms/10")`, walk subtree
structural traversal, tier 1
- 4 `follow_references(outbound)`
reference closure into exit machinery, tier 1
- 5 `legislation("Insolvency Act 1986")`
normalised statute node, corpus-wide

GRAPH FRAGMENT



THE AGENT COMPOSES, THE GRAPH STAYS THE SOURCE OF TRUTH

Financial distress has its own machinery. The triggers and your monitoring rights sit in Joint Schedule 7, and a Default opens the rectification route in the Core Terms.

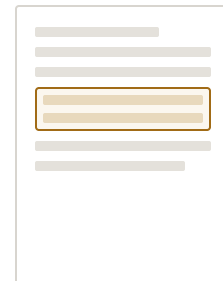
joint-schedule-7/3.1 · p.165 core-terms/10.3 · p.10

Default is a defined term whose meaning chains through Supplier, so the subcontractor question routes through the same definitions. The termination grounds in clause 10 name exactly which clauses' breach counts.

joint-schedule-1 · p.119 core-terms/10 · p.10

If it comes to exit, the obligations on termination live in the exit schedule, reached by following resolved references out of the termination clauses.

call-off-schedule-10/2 · p.363



Every claim walks back to ink

A citation resolves ref to provision to page, and the viewer renders the page with the box drawn. Absolute page and the part's own printed page both kept, because the printed page is what a lawyer quotes.

```
cite(path) → page image + bbox
```

THE ROUTE IS TRACEABLE, NOT JUST THE ANSWER

Each answer records its query plan and the hops it took, which nodes, which edge types, in what order. That matters most when no human is in the moment. In long-running multi-agent work, agents act on graph responses and every such decision has to be explainable afterwards. Typed edges make the reasoning symbolic and deductive, an auditable chain a monitor can replay, rather than a similarity score with no account of itself.

What the tiers buy. The concept filter finds the neighbourhood no keyword names. The vocabulary carries the legal machinery. The structure and its refs prove every word. Unresolved references stay visible instead of vanishing, so the agent can say what it could not connect.